

DAY 29: CUT THE COST OF CLEANING SUPPLIES

Cleaning is not my strong suit. In fact, I've seriously considered hiring a house cleaner to do all the dusting, mopping, and vacuuming for me, but my frugal nature does not even want to consider hiring out something I can, and definitely should be doing myself. (Note: This does not mean I have a problem with others using a cleaning service...at least not as long as you can happily afford one!)

The thing is, I know what the power of a clean home can do. It improves my mood, makes me happier, and I'm much less stressed living in a tidy and well-kept home. The problem is, because I don't particularly enjoy this task (like, *at all*), I always spend way too much on cleaning supplies that promise a clean home without the backbreaking effort.

You know what I'm talking about, right? Shower sprays that promise to wipe away soap scum without scrubbing, or dishwasher packs that leave glasses sparkling and crystal clear. I also get swayed by pretty packaging and all things organic and non-toxic. Who wants to inhale cancer-causing fumes? Not me. So even if my cleaning isn't fun, at least the storage baskets under my sink are filled with extremely organized and gorgeous looking bottles!

But all those products are incredibly expensive to purchase, and hardly necessary. Despite what the labels in the cleaning aisle promote, you don't need separate cleaners for the sink, floors, showers, and counters. Nor do you have to spend hours clipping coupons to score brand-name products for free.

These four tips show you how to save time and money as you vacuum, scrub toilets, mop the floors, and wipe away grime in all crevices and corners of your home. You can spend less and still create the crumb-free, germ-free haven you crave!

1. MAKE YOUR OWN